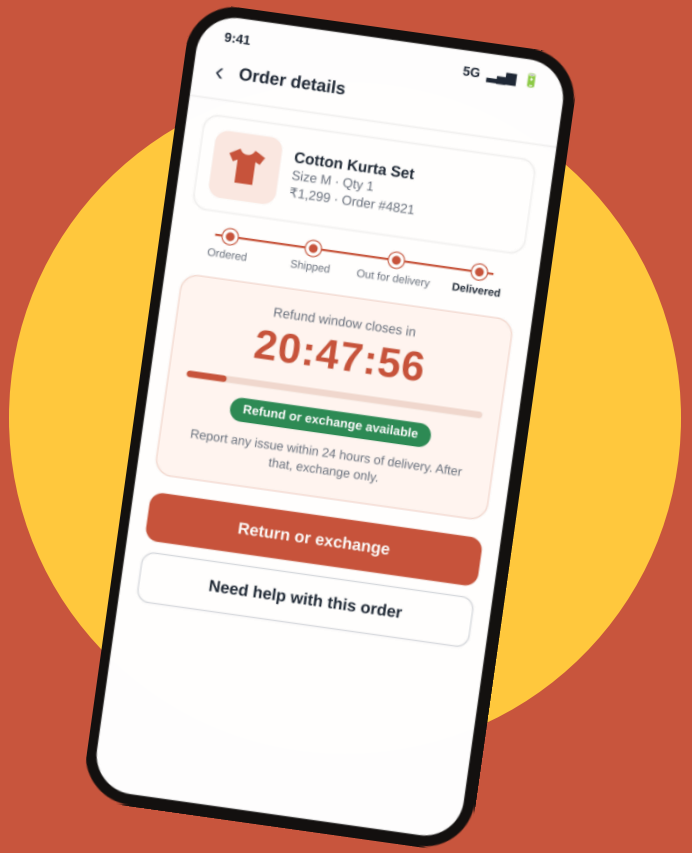
PRODUCT CASE STUDY

The 24-Hour Refund Window

Cutting use-and-return abuse in fashion e-commerce, without punishing honest buyers



Worn clothes are coming back

25-40%

Typical fashion return rate in India (seller benchmarks)

Rs 200-450

Cost of one return to a seller

Festive peak

Returns spike around Navratri and Diwali outfits

Sellers lose money when a customer wears an item and returns it for a full refund. The item can’t be resold at full price, and return shipping lands on the seller.

Platforms already feel this

Flipkart, 2020

Cut its fashion return window from 30 to 10 days, citing fraudulent returns (as reported).

October 2026

A viral video showed piles of returned Navratri outfits at a delivery hub, with people allegedly wearing them first.



Today vs the new rule

Today

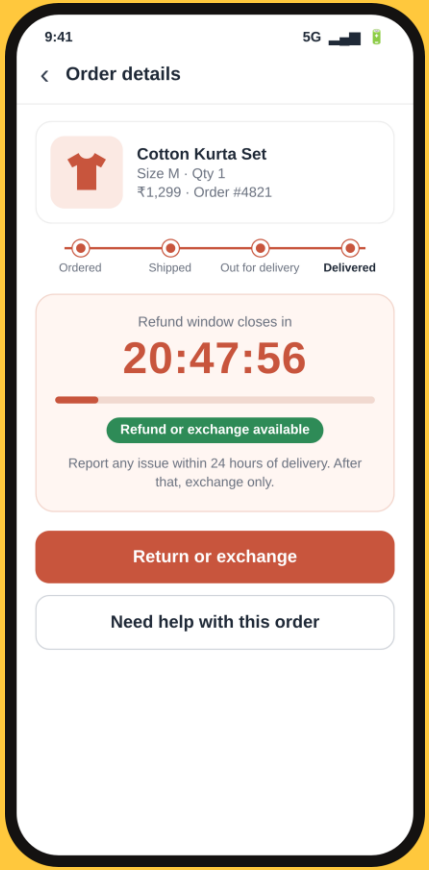
- Refund stays open for 10 days
- Reason does not affect eligibility
- Wear it once, return for full money

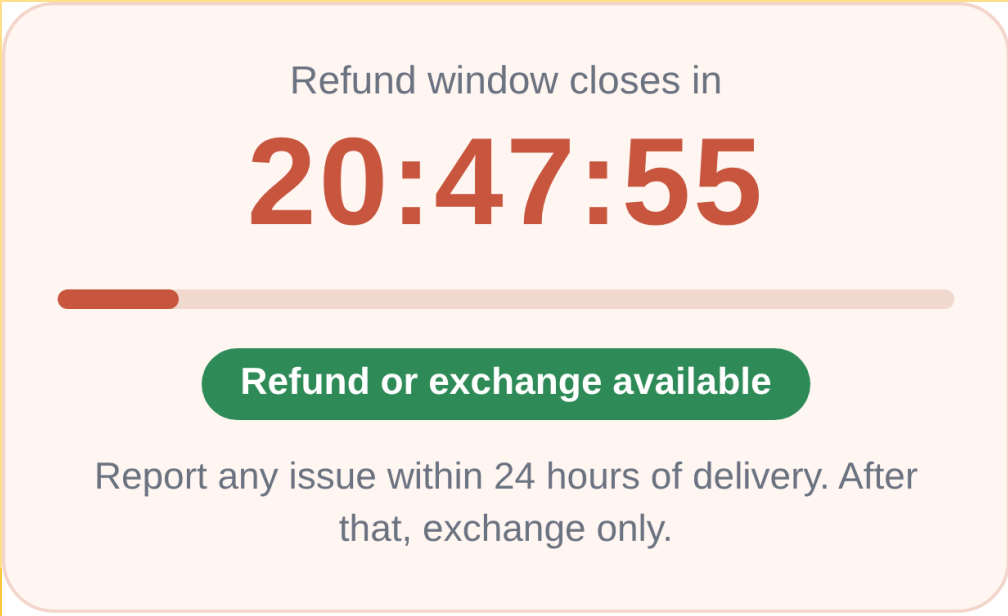
Proposed

- 0-24h: refund or exchange
- After 24h: exchange only
- Verified defect or wrong item: refund anytime

Lifestyle: Watch, T-Shirt, Footwear, Sari, Short, Dress, Kid's (Capri, Shorts & Tops), Men's (Ethnic Wear, Shirt, Formals, Jeans, Clothing Accessory), Women's (Ethnic Wear, Fabric, Blouse, Jean, Skirt, Trousers, Bra), Bags, Raincoat, Sunglass, Belt, Frame, Backpack, Suitcase, Luggage, etc...	10 days
Lifestyle: Jewellery, Footwear Accessories, Travel Accessories, Watch Accessories, etc..	Refund, Replacement or Exchange
Lifestyle: WinterWear(sweatshirt, jacket, sweater, cardigan, kids_thermal, pullover, windcheater, track_suit, thermal,shawl, track_top, glove, muffler, scarf, blazer, uniform_sweatshirt, uniform_blazer, kids_muffler, kids_mitten, shrug, poncho,uniform_sweater, cap, waistcoat, leg_warmer, legging,elder_halloween_costume)	

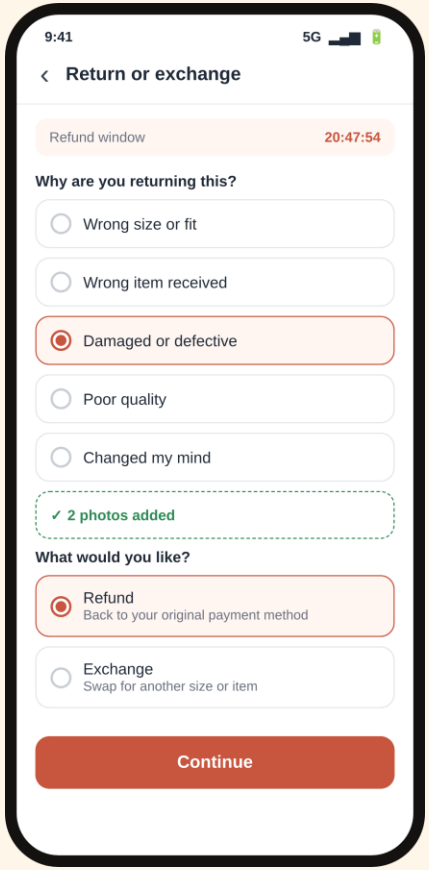
A live timer from delivery

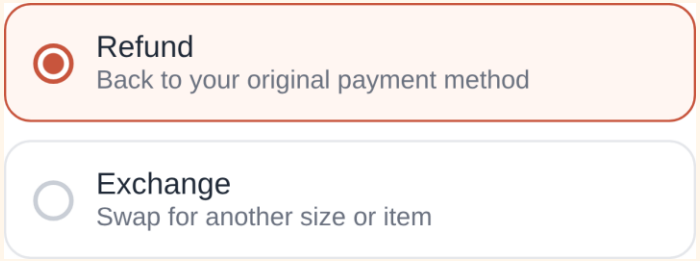




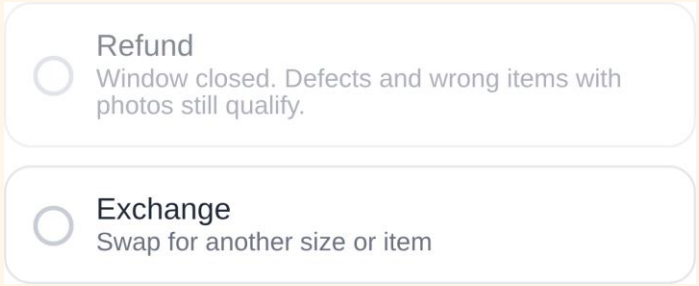
- **Live countdown starts at the delivery scan**
- **Progress bar shows how much of the window is gone**

Same flow, different outcome



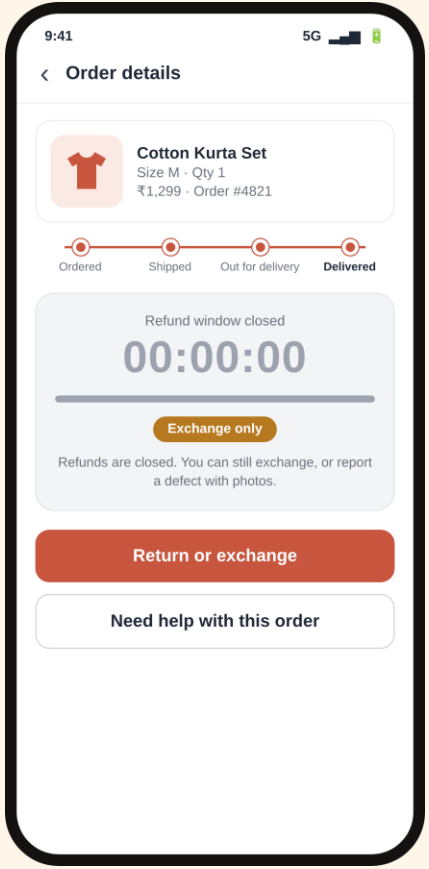


Inside the window
Or a defect with photos: refund unlocks



After 24 hours
Poor quality: refund locked, exchange stays open

After 24 hours, and how we measure it



Success metrics

- Return rate and share of returns flagged as worn
- Genuine-defect approvals stay high
- Exchange rate up, conversion holds

Risks and fixes

- Late defects: photo-proof exception
- Size out of stock: item of equal value
- Parcel opened late: clock starts at delivery

Pilot it before rolling out

1

Pick clothing sellers and 10% of festive orders

2

Run 4 weeks: new policy vs current policy

3

Compare returns, worn-item share, and conversion

The ask: a small pilot on one clothing category to test whether a 24-hour refund window cuts worn returns without hurting sales.